

[KAI[FRAME] · FTM MASC BUILD PROTOCOL · v1.0]

ENGINEER YOUR FRAME.

24 MONTHS · GYM-BASED · BUILT FOR FTM + TRANSMASC BODIES
FREE. ALWAYS.

[00 · from kai]

READ THIS FIRST.

No fluff. This is a 24-month body protocol built specifically for FTM and transmasculine bodies. The goal is to engineer a masculine frame through resistance training, smart nutrition, and understanding how your body actually works.

Assumptions: you have gym access, you're past P3 of puberty naturally or 12+ months into HRT. If you're not there yet – this still works. The timeline might differ slightly but the principles are identical.

*"I built this because the fitness industry either ignores us or gives us watered-down BS. You deserve the real program. So here it is. **Read every section before you start.**"*

[03 · phase 01 · months 0-6]

FOUNDATION. LEARN YOUR BODY.

Upper/lower split, 4 days/week, sub-45 mins. Focus on movement quality over weight. Build the patterns that all future gains run on.

DAY 1 – LOWER A

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Lunges	4 × 10/leg	2-1-2	Drive up, not forward
Hip Thrusts	3 × 15	2-0-3	Squeeze at the top
Calf Raises	4 × 12	1-0-3	Full stretch at bottom

DAY 2 – UPPER A

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Bicep Curls	3 × 8	3-1-2	Full extension at bottom
Tricep Extensions	3 × 8	3-1-2	Elbows locked
Push-Ups	4 × 12	2-0-2	Full ROM only
Knee Tucks	3 × 15	1-1-3	Slow the eccentric

DAY 3 – LOWER B

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Squats	4 × 6	2-1-2	Heavier – test limits
Hip Thrusts	3 × 6	2-0-3	Load it up vs Day 1
Hamstring Curls	4 × 10-12	2-1-3	Eccentric is the point
Leg Abductions	3 × 12-15	1-1-1	Controlled

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Low Rows	4 × 8-10	1-0-2	Row to stomach
Bench Press	2 × 12-15	2-1-2	Learn the bar path
Assisted Pull-Ups	4 × 8-10	2-0-2	Full hang at bottom
Knee Tucks	3 × 15	1-1-3	Controlled eccentric

[04 · phase 02 · months 6-12]

FRAME BUILD. V-TAPER SEASON.

Lats, shoulders, triceps. Geometry is your best friend. Track weights every single session — progressive overload starts now.

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Squats	4 × 6-10	2-0-2
Hip Thrusts	3 × 12-15	1-1-1
Hamstring Curls	3 × 8-15	1-1-3
Calf Raises	4 × 8-12	2-0-2

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Flat Bench Press	5 × 6-10	1-0-2

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Forearm Curls	3 × 10-18	1-1-2
Tricep Extensions	2 × 10-15	1-1-2
Bicep Curls	3 × 6-12	2-0-2

DAY 3 – LOWER + CORE

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
RDLs	4 × 10-15	2-1-2
Farmer's Carries	3 × 60 sec	N/A
Leg Extensions	3 × 8-12	1-1-2
Hamstring Curls	3 × 8-12	1-1-3

DAY 4 – UPPER PULL

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Dumbbell Incline Bench	3 × 6-8	2-0-2
Low Rows	4 × 8-10	2-0-2
Bicep Curls	3 × 10-12	3-1-2
Tricep Skis	3 × 10-12	3-1-2
Leg Raises	3 × 15	1-1-3

[05 · phase 03 · months 12-24]

FULL BODYBUILDING PROTOCOL.

Newbie gains are done. 5 days/week, heavier compounds, actual bodybuilding methodology. Read the progression section carefully — it matters more now than it ever did.

DAY 1 — LOWER MODERATE

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Squats	5 × 8-12	1-0-2
RDLs	3 × 6-10	2-1-1
Farmer's Carries	3 × 60 sec	N/A

DAY 2 — UPPER PUSH + PULL

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Bench Press	5 × 6-8	2-0-2
Rows	5 × 6-8	3-1-2
Tricep Skis	4 × 10-12	3-1-2
Bicep Curls	4 × 10-12	3-1-2

DAY 3 — LOWER HEAVY

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Deadlifts	5 × 3-5	Form focus
RDLs (light)	3 × 10-12	2-1-2
Hip Thrusts	3 × 12-15	2-0-3
Abductor + Adductor	3 × 10-12 each	1-1-3

DAY 4 — UPPER PUSH + CORE

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO
Incline Bench	5 × 6-10	1-0-1
Bicep Curls	4 × 10-12	2-1-2
Behind-the-Back Tricep Ext.	4 × 10-12	2-1-2
Suitcase Marches	3 × 60 sec	N/A
Leg Raises	4 × 10	1-0-2

DAY 5 — BACK + SHOULDERS

EXERCISE	SETS & REPS	TEMPO	NOTES
Lat Pulldowns	4 × 8-12	1-1-3	V-taper HQ. Controlled eccentric.
Chest-Supported Rows	4 × 5-10	1-1-2	Pure back work, no cheating.
Lateral Raises	5 × 12-15	1-0-2	Your silhouette secret weapon.
Shoulder Press	5 × 10-15	1-0-2	Don't lock out — keep tension.

[06 · progression]

HOW TO ACTUALLY GET STRONGER.

Track your weights. Every session. If you don't know what you lifted last week, you cannot progress. This is non-negotiable.

- Can do more reps than the top of your range? Add 5lb.
- Can't add weight? Add 1-2 reps per set.
- Can't add reps? Add one set for 2-4 weeks, then retry weight.
- Hit the top of your rep range consistently? Drop 2 reps and add weight.
- Rest 2-2.5 min for big muscles (legs, chest, back). 1.5 min for small (arms, shoulders).
- Stop 1-2 reps short of failure on most sets. Save true failure for the final set only.

EAT LIKE YOU MEAN IT.

MACRO TARGETS (EXAMPLE: 190LB, 5'10")

- **Protein:** 0.7–1g/lb bodyweight (160–190g)
- **Carbs:** ~350g
- **Fats:** ~75g
- **Total:** ~2750 kcal/day. Adjust ± 200 for bulk/cut.

HAND-PORTION METHOD (IF TRACKING TRIGGERS YOU)

Per meal, 4 meals/day: 2–3 fist portions protein, 2–3 fist portions carbs, palm-size fats, 3–4 portions veg/fruit.

SUPPLEMENT STACK

- **Creatine monohydrate** — 5g/day. Non-negotiable. Drink 120oz water daily.
- **Magnesium** — 250mg/day. Recovery + sleep quality.
- **Multivitamin** — after 6 months of solid eating. Insurance, not maintenance.

RECOVERY

Sleep minimum 7 hours. Optimal 8–9. Sleep deprivation directly reduces muscle protein synthesis, strength progression, and daily energy. It's not optional.

WHAT DROPS NEXT.

DIY HRT: WHAT YOU NEED TO KNOW

Self-administered HRT — pharmacology, sourcing landscape, dosing protocols, and harm reduction. No judgment. Just information.

[COMING SOON]

ADVANCED TRAINING: PERIODIZATION FOR FTM BODIES

Block periodization, peaking cycles, deload programming, and specialization phases for when you've outgrown beginner programming.

[COMING SOON]

CONFIDENCE + SOCIAL PASSING: THE REAL STUFF

Body language, vocal training, gendered spaces, building social confidence as a transmasculine person.

[COMING SOON]

FTM GROOMING: THE ACTUAL GUIDE

Beard care from day one on T, skincare for changing skin texture, haircuts for your face shape, grooming basics.

[COMING SOON]

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